

STARTER

Field-by-Field Application Walkthrough

New Zealand - Visitor Visa: NZeTA vs. full application, and how to apply

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start: check which pathway you actually need

Most nationalities don't need a Visitor Visa for New Zealand at all - they need an NZeTA (New Zealand Electronic Travel Authority), a separate, much simpler online authorisation. A full Visitor Visa application, covered by this guide, is only required for non-waiver nationalities, or for stays and circumstances the NZeTA doesn't cover.

NZeTA IS NOT A VISA

If your nationality is visa-waiver, you request an NZeTA online before travel and pay the International Visitor Conservation and Tourism Levy (IVL) alongside it - a materially simpler and cheaper process than a Visitor Visa application. Confirm which category applies to you before assuming you need the full application process covered in this pack.

If you do need a full Visitor Visa, gather:

- Valid passport, with at least 3 months' validity beyond your planned departure from New Zealand
- A completed online application via Immigration New Zealand's (INZ) online account system
- Evidence of a genuine, temporary visit - a specific reason and plan, not just funds
- Financial evidence - see the Financial Requirements Overview (Essential tier) for INZ's specific per-month guideline
- Evidence of onward or return travel
- If your case is weaker on ties or funds: a completed INZ 1025 Sponsorship Form from a New Zealand-based sponsor

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport.

2. Purpose and travel history

- State your specific purpose clearly - tourism, visiting family/friends, or another temporary purpose
- Declare any previous visits to New Zealand and any visa refusals from any country

3. Health and character

Declare any relevant health conditions and criminal history. Depending on your nationality, intended length of stay, and personal history, INZ may require a chest X-ray/medical certificate or a police certificate before deciding your application.

4. Financial information

How you'll fund your stay - see the Financial Requirements Overview for INZ's specific monthly guideline figures.

5. Pay the fee and levy

Pay the Visitor Visa application fee, which includes the IVL for most applicants applying this way.

6. Submit and wait for a decision

Applications are generally decided without an interview, based on the written file and any supporting documents requested.